NEW STARS MEET OLD ICONS

The legends still occupy the heights of the rankings, but the young bloods are breaking through. The future belongs to the likes of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Divya Deshmukh

By **SUHANI SINGH**



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There's a new kid on the block giving our cricketing icons—Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma—a run for their money not just in the Indian Premier League (IPL) but also in INDIA TODAY's Mood of the Nation poll. Fifteen-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's scintillating ball-striking in this IPL, which earned him both the Emerging Player and Most Valuable Player awards, was fresh on everybody's mind as he made his maiden appearance in the poll. Significantly, another legend, M.S. Dhoni, has been pushed to No. 4 for the first time in years. Hardik Pandya drops out of the top five, with Test and ODI captain Shubman Gill taking his spot.

Among women cricketers, there is little surprise, as all key members of the 2025 ODI World Cup-winning squad are present: vice captain Smriti Mandhana, captain Harmanpreet Kaur, all-rounder Deepti Sharma, opener Shafali Verma and batter and ace fielder Jemimah Rodrigues. The quintet was also part of India's recent

Q. WHO DO YOU THINK IS INDIA'S NO. 1 MALE CRICKETER?

1 **VIRAT KOHLI** 31.8 [43]



2 **ROHIT SHARMA** 15.4 [9.1]



3 **VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI** 12.1 [NA]



4 **MS DHONI** 8.1 [13.4]



5 **SHUBMAN GILL** 4.8 [2.8]